



Bat

Think how hard it must be to fly fast in the dark. Insect-eating bats, such as the long-eared myotis, have expert skills so they can zip around at night without bumping into things! They make lots of high-pitched squeaks that bounce off trees, buildings, and other objects as echoes. The bats listen for the echoes to create a “sound picture” in their brain. This technique of echolocation lets them track down tasty moths to eat.

In many spooky stories human-like monsters called vampires drink blood and can transform into bats to fly. There are a few species of bats that drink blood, but they live in rainforests and mainly feed from pig-like tapirs or farm animals. Bats are the only mammals that are able to fly.